ADMINISTRATION FOR CHILDREN & FAMILIES
Children's Bureau | 330 C Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20201
www.acf.gov/cb

December 23, 2025

Janee Harvey
Division Director
Family Well-Being and Protection
Department of Health and Human Services
1305 E Walnut Street
Des Moines, IA 50319-0114

Dear Director Harvey:

This letter serves as the Children's Bureau (CB) response to Iowa's December 8, 2025, submission of an Implementation Advance Planning Document (IAPD) for the State of Iowa's new Comprehensive Child Welfare Information System (CCWIS), VISION. Thank you for your partnership and vision in reimagining CCWIS for the State of Iowa. Under the leadership of Governor Kim Reynolds and the Iowa Department of Health and Human Services, it is clear this effort is a top priority for the state and reflects a strong commitment to advancing implementation on an accelerated timeline.

I want to personally thank the project team for its dedication to making CCWIS a top priority, as well as for its timely communication and collaborative approach to advancing this work on behalf of Iowa's children, families, and workforce. CB is committed to partnering with the state to support a timely and successful CCWIS implementation, recognizing the critical role the system plays in advancing the agency's mission and ensuring the safety and well-being of children and families. This effort also advances the Administration's goals to modernize child welfare data systems and improve the health and well-being of Americans. It is my particular pleasure to be in a position to approve a CCWIS project that is innovative, forward-looking, and grounded in strong partnership.

CB conditionally approves the APD and **$45,786,250** in CCWIS development funding for calendar year 2026. This approval is conditional upon Iowa addressing identified project risk items by submitting satisfactory documentation as described in the section titled *"Requested Actions and Submissions"* within **60 calendar days of January 5, 2026**. CB remains available to provide technical assistance to support the State's efforts to mitigate these risks. CB is also relying on the State's representations that its procurement complies with applicable State and local legal requirements and acquisition laws. While it is not CB's intention to unnecessarily invoke federal regulatory enforcement, the State remains responsible for providing the required materials to CB's satisfaction within the specified timeframe. If the materials are not provided accordingly, the Administration for Children and Families (ACF) may suspend or recoup CCWIS funding in accordance with applicable federal requirements under 45 CFR 1355.58.

The following table lists the funding approval.

Project 3 – VISION					
Control	Project Total	Total IV-E	Percent Eligible for CCWIS Funding	Total CCWIS Eligible Amount	CCWIS FFP @50%
This letter: IA_2025_12_11_CB	*$45,786,250*	*$45,786,250*	100%	*$45,786,250*	*$22,893,125*
Total Approved	$45,786,250	$45,786,250	100%	$45,786,250	$22,893,125

The state must claim all Iowa CCWIS costs as Project 3 on the appropriate lines of the CB-496.

Requested Actions and Submissions

To enable CB to continue support for this project, the State must complete the following actions and submissions to CB's satisfaction within 60 calendar days of January 5, 2026.

Project Governance

- The State must establish a formal project governance structure and submit a governance charter that clearly defines:
  - Governance bodies and membership
  - Roles, responsibilities, and decision-making authority
  - Escalation paths for issues affecting scope, schedule, cost, or risk
- The State must establish a regular governance meeting cadence and provide documentation of meeting outcomes.
- The State must maintain a weekly project challenges and dependencies log that identifies:
  - Key risks and dependencies
  - Potential impacts to scope, schedule, cost, or operations
  - Planned mitigation actions, responsible parties, and target dates

  This log must be made available to CB.
- The State must establish monthly check-in meetings with CB staff to discuss project status and key updates.

Scope, Schedule, and Roadmap

- The State must submit and maintain a comprehensive project roadmap organized by capabilities or releases.
- The State must establish and maintain an Integrated Master Schedule (IMS) that includes:
  - Major milestones and planned release dates
  - Critical path activities and key dependencies
- For the first 60 calendar days following January 5, 2026, the State must maintain weekly status reports reflecting budget, scope, and schedule performance against the approved APD and accompanying documentation.
- To support future sustainability of the VISION system, the State must submit a procurement strategy for future maintenance and operations (M&O) contracts.

These requirements are intended to support continued collaboration between the Administration for Children and Families (ACF), CB, and the State, and to ensure that CCWIS development proceeds in a transparent, accountable manner aligned with federal requirements. By addressing the identified risks and completing the required submissions, the State will enable ACF and CB to provide effective oversight and technical assistance in support of successful system implementation and improved outcomes for children and families.

The Annual APD Update for Project 3 is due November 1, 2026. If additional assistance is needed, please contact CB_APD_Submissions@acf.hhs.gov ,CB_APD_Submissions@acf.hhs.gov.

Sincerely,

REESE C. INMAN -S

Digitally signed by REESE C. INMAN -S
Date: 2025.12.23 07:55:28 -05'00'

Cody Inman
Delegated Commissioner
Administration on Children, Youth, and Families

Reference: IA_2025_12_11_CB

cc: Kendall Darling, Regional Program Manager, CB, Region 7, Kansas City, MO
Janice Realeza, Grants Management Officer, ACF, Region 3, Philadelphia, PA